HOW TO WRITE RESEARCH PROPOSAL

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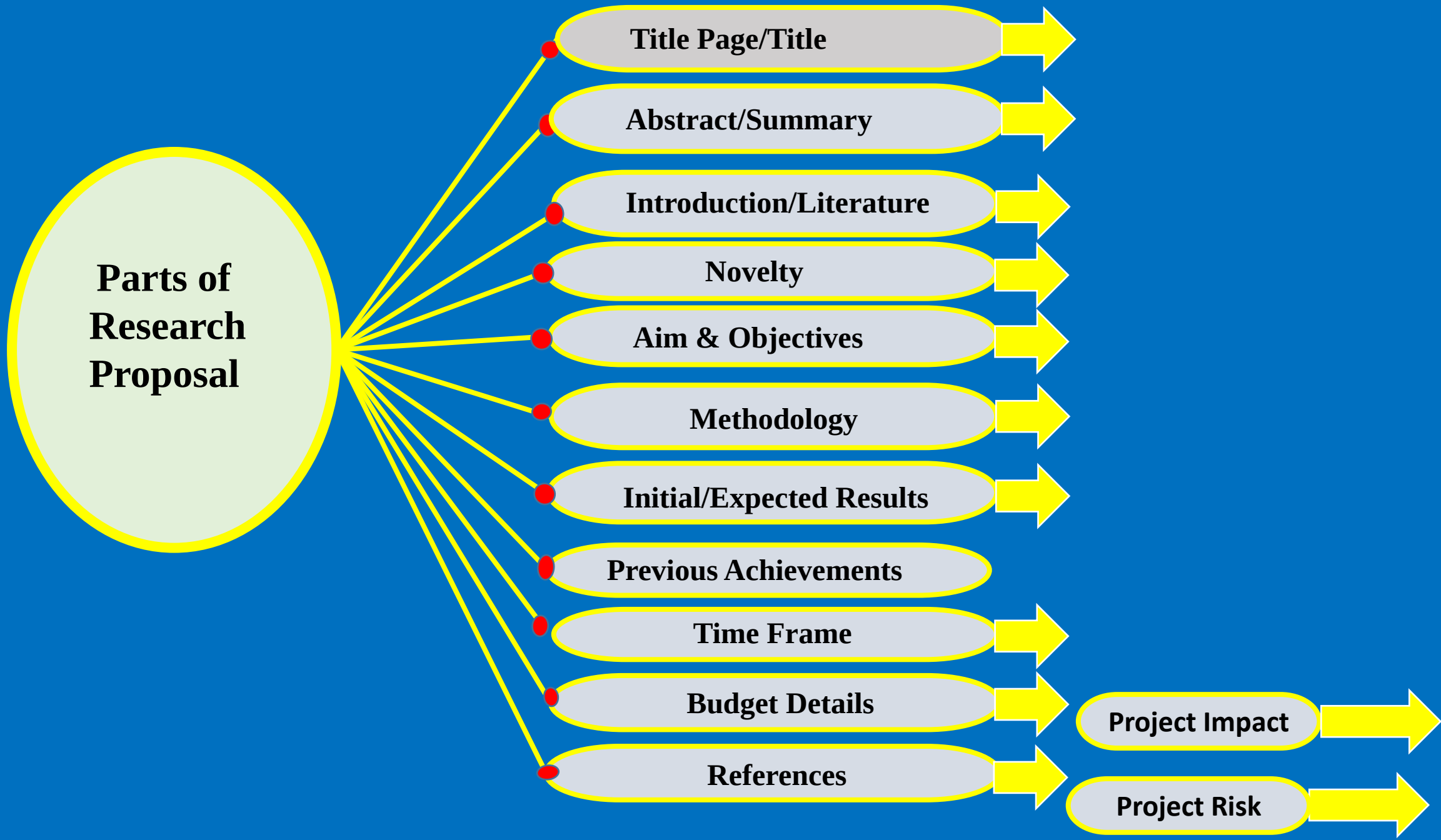
How to Write Research Proposal



Research proposal is a formal document or concise summary of proposed research/project.

Covering the following aspects:

- *What do you want to do, and how do you plan to do it?*
- *What has already been done in the area of your project?*
- *How will the results be evaluated?*
- *How much will it cost, and how much time will it take?*
- *How does the proposed project relate to the sponsor's interests?*
- *What difference will the project make to:*
  - ✓ *Your University*
  - ✓ *Students*
  - ✓ *Discipline,*
  - ✓ *The state*
  - ✓ *The nation, or any other concerned parties? etc*


Parts of Research Proposal
Title Page/Title
Abstract/Summary
Introduction/Literature
Novelty
Aim & Objectives
Methodology
Initial/Expected Results
Previous Achievements
Time Frame
Budget Details
References
Project Impact
Project Risk

THANKS

TITLE / TITLE PAGE

- *Concise*
- *Capitalized words*
- *Avoid Abbreviations*
- *Complete Meaning Full*

- *Name of Applicant & Designation*
- *Name of Supervisor & Designation (if any)*
- *Name of University/Department*
- *Date of Submission*
- *Submitting Agency Name*

ABSTRACT / SUMMARY

- *Effective summary to the addressed problem/s*
- *Identifies the solution/s*
- *Specifies the objectives and methods of the project*
- *Outline funding requirements (amount/equipments/time frame etc)*
- *Describe the applicant's ability and previous achievements (Pub/Grant)*
- *Highlights Institution facilities (Lab/Research center/Policies) etc.*
- *Avoid Citations & References*
- *Max 350/250 words (depend on the requirements)*

ABSTRACT / SUMMARY

Abstract

Purpose – This study aims to explore the effect of human resource (HR) strategy (e.g. empowerment and teamwork) on green supply chain integration (e.g. green supplier and customer integration), which further leads to economic performance. Moreover, the authors examined the moderating effects of information systems and mutual trust on the relationship between HR strategy and green supply chain integration.

Design/methodology/approach – Using the empirical data from 213 Chinese manufacturing firms, this study uses structural equation modeling and hierarchical regressions to examine the conceptual model.

Findings – The study's findings reveal that empowerment and teamwork positively enhance green supplier and customer integration. Green supplier and customer integration are positively related to economic performance. Moreover, information systems positively moderate the relationship between empowerment and green supplier integration but negatively moderate the relationship between teamwork and green supplier/customer integration. Mutual trust positively moderates the relationship between empowerment and green supplier integration and the relationship between teamwork and green customer integration.

Originality/value – This study extends the existing understanding regarding how to enhance green supply chain integration by adopting an appropriate HR strategy in the context of different levels of information systems and mutual trust.

Keywords HR strategy, Green supply chain integration, Mutual trust, Information systems, Economic performance

INTRODUCTION / LITERATURE

- *Consistency*
- *Literature Review (background)*
- *Statement of Problem*
- *Purpose of Research*
- *Significance of Research*
- *Proper/relevant/latest citations*
- *Try to cite high impact factor journals*
- *Avoid similarities (Plagiarism)*
- *Latest research*

Novelty

Novelty in research refers to the introduction of a new idea or a unique perspective that adds to the existing knowledge in a particular field of study. It involves bringing something fresh and original to the table that has not been done before or exploring an existing topic in a new and innovative way.

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QUALITY PAPER

The effect of relational investments on supply chain quality integration: protection or constraint of legal bonds?

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customers can measure the product's interface with the ongoing processes and provide valuable feedback to manufacturing firms (Harrigan *et al.*, 2018; Parahoo, 2013), and CQI aims to build a long-term customer partnership that delivers financial benefits (Park *et al.*, 2013).

Social exchange theory (SET) argues that business activities among various stakeholders are rooted in relational investments that encourage establishing long-term relationships (Cook *et al.*, 2013; Burns, 1973). Relational investments comprise mutual trust, communication and goal congruence, etc., which may be worthwhile for reciprocity relationships (Dang *et al.*, 2021; Kuei *et al.*, 2008). Manufacturing firms make increasing relational investments for quality improvement, but few related studies emphasized how they affect quality integration in the supply chain context (Yu and Huo, 2018, 2019). Commitment and involvement are two typical relational investments devoted to reciprocity relationships (Chien and Chen, 2010; Kingshott, 2006). Commitment helps to minimize costs and improve product quality through process layouts (Pérez and Sánchez, 2001). On the other hand, partners' involvement helps to overcome communication barriers in the product design-to-manufacturing process (Tao *et al.*, 2020; Patrucco *et al.*, 2020). However, due to the attributes of relational investments, they may require legal bonds to regulate and normalize supply chain partnerships (Dyer and Singh, 1998; Carey *et al.*, 2011). However, there may be discrepancies about whether legal bonds bring positive or negative outcomes. Thus, based on SET, this study seeks to investigate the framework incorporating relational investments (e.g. supplier/customer commitment and involvement), supply chain quality integration (e.g. SQI and CQI) and financial performance, as well as the contingent effects of legal bonds on the relationship between relational investments and supply chain quality integration. Specifically, three fundamental research questions are proposed:

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The effect of human resource strategy on green supply chain integration: the moderating role of information systems and mutual trust

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empowerment are often considered important stategies for green practices (Molina-Azorin *et al.*, 2021). For instance, Marks and Spencer has introduced a clothing recycling trunk in-store and donates proceeds to Oxfam (a nonprofit organization). An employee came up with the idea for the boxes, which was backed by the board and ended up being very successful. Despite the practical importance, few studies have been undertaken to examine the effect of empowerment and teamwork on green supply chain practice (Dubois and Dubois, 2012; Kumar *et al.*, 2019).

Socio-technical system theory offers a fascinating view by incorporating social and technical systems that create customer-focused products and services (Walker *et al.*, 2008). The social and technical elements create social integration in the social system and technological integration in the technical system (Shan *et al.*, 2022). By integrating these factors, firms may maximize productivity, collaboration, and customer happiness. Several HR studies have highlighted the significance of information systems, which is a fundamental ability to acquire and disseminate integrated information from internal and external sources (Galanaki *et al.*, 2019). Information systems can further strengthen human efficiency through employees' communication, involvement, maintenance, and development tasks (Mishra and Akman, 2010). Similarly, mutual trust between supply chain parties encourages joint planning, transparent information sharing, and measures to mitigate risk (Barrane *et al.*, 2021). However, there is a lack of understanding of how information systems and mutual trust influence the effects of HR strategy. Thus, this study aims to explore the role of HR strategy (e.g. empowerment and teamwork) in enhancing GSCI, as well as the moderating role of information systems and mutual trust, which can be specified as the following research questions:

Embracing green supply chain collaboration through technologies: the bridging role of advanced manufacturing technology

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Despite the significance of IT and AMT, it is still unclear how these bundles of technologies promote green collaboration in the supply chain context (Bai and Sarkis, 2017).

Technological resources enable information sharing and coordination of competitive approaches among supply chain partners (Lioukas *et al.*, 2016). For example, Fawcett *et al.* (2011) stated that technological resources reshape and reconfigure the supply chain operation responsible for value generation. Efficient ecological information and communication can strengthen environmental coordination, encouraging the creation and use of novel supply chain collaboration (Chugh *et al.*, 2016; Bai and Sarkis, 2017). The ability to develop unique these technological resources is profoundly the dynamic capability that makes firms more flexible, which helps to adjust market trends and establish sustainable advantages (Liao *et al.*, 2009). Dynamic capability is "the capacity to integrate, build, and reconfigure internal and external competencies to address a rapidly changing environment" (Teece *et al.*, 1997). However, previous studies argued that GSCC helps to achieve "win–win" economic benefits but mostly focuses on the conceptual level and failed to specify different roles of green internal, supplier and customer collaboration in environmental and economic performance (Yang *et al.*, 2011; Zhu *et al.*, 2013). To fill these research gaps, wbased on the dynamic capability theory, we develop a comprehensive framework comprising information and manufacturing technologies, GSCC and economic and environmental performance, which can be specified into three research questions as follows:

DIFFERENCE B/W AIM & OBJECTIVES

Aim refers to the overall purpose or the general statement of what you hope to achieve. It is broad and represents the ultimate goal or the big-picture outcome

Objectives are specific, measurable steps or actions that must be taken to achieve the aim. They are narrower in focus and detail what needs to be done in a step-by-step manner

For Example

DIFFERENCE B/W AIM & OBJECTIVES

Aspects	Aims	Objectives
Definition	A broad, general statement that describes what the research intends to achieve overall.	Specific, actionable steps that describe how the research aim will be achieved.
Focus	Big picture goals of the research	Specific research tasks or activities that must be carried out to achieve those goals.
Scope	Broader in scope and provide a general direction for the research	Narrower in scope and provide specific details about what the research will investigate and how it be carried out.
Context	Abstract and theoretical	Concrete and operational

DIFFERENCE B/W AIM & OBJECTIVES

	Aims	Objectives
Example	To explore the impact of digital learning tools on students' academic performance.	1. To assess students' perceptions of digital learning tools. 2. To analyze the relationship between tool usage frequency and grades. 3. To identify challenges students, face while using digital tools.

DIFFERENCE B/W AIM & OBJECTIVES

	Aims	Objectives
Example	To investigate the effect of fiscal decentralization on healthcare service delivery in Pakistan.	1. To compare provincial healthcare expenditures before and after fiscal decentralization. 2. To analyze the impact on key health indicators infant mortality rate (IMR), maternal mortality ratio (MMR), vaccination rates). 3. To identify regional disparities in resource allocation.

METHODOLOGY

Methodology is the overall description of your approach

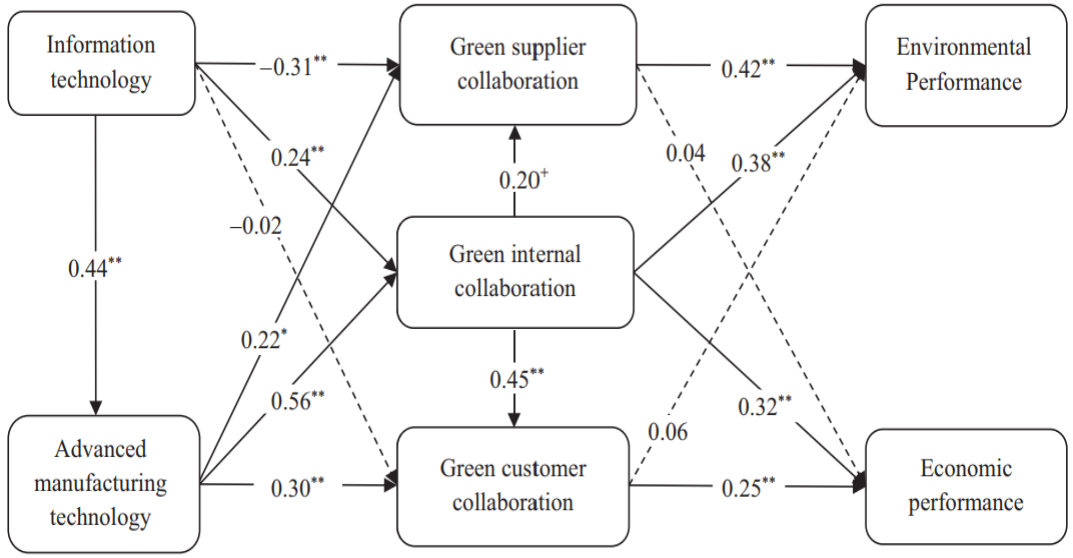
- *Materials such as Chemicals*
- *Instrumentation*
- *Data Collection*
- *Analysis of Results*
- *Comparative analysis of your achievements with other Literatures*
- *Justification of results by literature (if required)*
- *Outcomes – Brief Explanation or Claiming for Novelty*

INITIAL / EXPECTED RESULTS

Structural Equation Modeling Results

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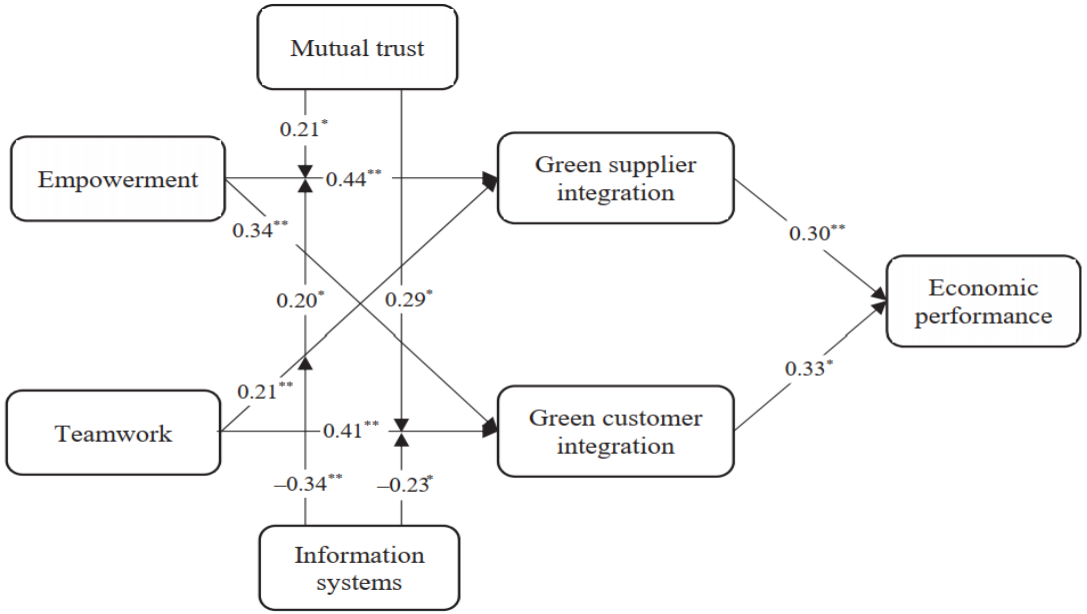
Notes: $^{+}p < 0.10$; $^{*}p < 0.05$; $^{**}p < 0.01$

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The effect of human resource strategy on green supply chain integration: the moderating role of information systems and mutual trust

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Note(s): $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$

Time Frame

Duration	Activity
Sept. 2024 – Feb. 2025	Starting the research: conduct an in-depth review of relevant literature, refine research questions, design the conceptual/theoretical framework, develop survey/interview instruments, pilot-test questionnaires, seek ethical approval (if required), finalize sampling strategy.
March 2025 – Aug 2025	Research Phase 1: Data collection (e.g., surveys, interviews, secondary data compilation), field visits if applicable, begin coding and entering data, preliminary descriptive analysis. Prepare initial conference abstracts or working papers.
Sept. 2025 – Feb. 2026	Research Phase 2: Advanced data analysis (e.g., regression, SEM, panel data models), test hypotheses, discuss findings with peers for feedback, revise conceptual framework if needed, present preliminary results at seminars/conferences, start drafting journal articles.
March 2026 – Aug 2026	Writing the final thesis or research report, completing journal submissions, preparing policy briefs (if relevant), presenting findings at international conferences/workshops, finalizing recommendations and conclusions.

Budget Details



HEC Sample; BU Budget Sample

Budget Elements

HR Cost

– against number of Years

- *Principal Investigator (PI)*
- *COPI (no depend on PI/Project*
- *Research associate/s*
- *Students*
  - *PhD*
  - *MS*
  - *Undergraduate*

the lead person responsible for the overall direction, management, and reporting of a project or grant.

Co-Principal Investigator) , shares responsibility with the PI for the scientific/technical direction and management of the project.

Equipments

- *PC, printer, Electrodes, Amplifiers, Golink, software's, etc*

Consumables

Beakers, pipettes, papers, Chemicals etc.

Service Costs

- *Access to scientific equipment, data streams, etc*
- *contract for repair/ maintenance of sed scientific equipment*
- *Subscription to open access journals or publications*
- *Management Cost for organizing national level conferences, workshops, or seminars*
- *Travel Costs – Conferences (international, national)*

References Tools

References

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- *Endnote*
- *Mendeley*
- *Zotero*

HEC Sample;

IMPACT OF THE PROPOSED PROJECT/PROPOSAL

- *Why the proposed research is important*
- *Why it would be a timely contribution to research in this field*
- *why the proposed research is important in national context*
- *how the project will support socioeconomic development in Pakistan*

HEC Sample; BU Budget Sample

IMPACT OF THE PROPOSED PROJECT/PROPOSAL

- Due to this study, educators and policymakers will gain insights into how students perceive the usefulness, ease of use, and overall satisfaction with digital tools. This will help in validating the relevance of digital interventions and ensuring that future implementations are aligned with learners' needs, ultimately improving engagement and adoption rates.

- Due to this study, stakeholders will have clear, evidence-based findings on whether increased usage of digital learning tools actually leads to better academic performance. This will guide decision-makers on resource allocation, scheduling, and support for these tools, ensuring that investments are data-driven and outcome-oriented.

- Due to this study, barriers such as connectivity issues, lack of digital literacy, or platform usability problems will be systematically documented. These findings will inform actionable strategies for removing obstacles, thus increasing equity and accessibility in education.

HEC Sample; BU Budget Sample

SUCCESS CRITERIA TABLE

WP No	Objective of WP	Success Criteria	Success %
01	Development of conceptual framework and research instruments	Completion of a comprehensive literature review, validated conceptual framework, and pre-tested survey/interview instruments. Ethical approval secured.	100%
02	Sampling design and data collection	Representative sample recruited, data collection completed (surveys, interviews, LMS logs). Response rate ≥ 70% (or as per proposal target).	100%
03	Data cleaning and preliminary analysis	Clean dataset prepared, descriptive statistics and initial patterns identified. Missing data < 5% and handled appropriately.	100%
04	Advanced data analysis and hypothesis testing	Successful execution of planned statistical techniques (e.g., regression, SEM), significant results interpreted with theoretical linkage.	100%
05	Results validation and stakeholder feedback	Presentation of preliminary results to peers/stakeholders, feedback incorporated, revised analysis if needed.	100%
06	Report writing and dissemination	Final report/thesis prepared, submission of at least one journal article/conference paper, dissemination of findings in seminars/workshops.	100%

Project Weaknesses

Weakness	Explanation	Effect
Small Sample Size	Not enough participants or data points are included in the study.	Results may not be reliable or statistically significant.
Data Collection Bias	The way data is gathered may introduce unfairness or inaccuracies.	Findings could be distorted, leading to inaccurate conclusions.
Lack of Resources	Insufficient funding, staff, or equipment.	Limits the scope and quality of the research.
Uncontrolled Variables	External factors that aren't accounted for can affect the results.	Confusing outcomes make it hard to draw valid conclusions.
Pressure to Publish	Desire for positive or publishable results may introduce bias in reporting or analysis.	The integrity and objectivity of the research can be compromised.

HEC Sample; BU Budget Sample

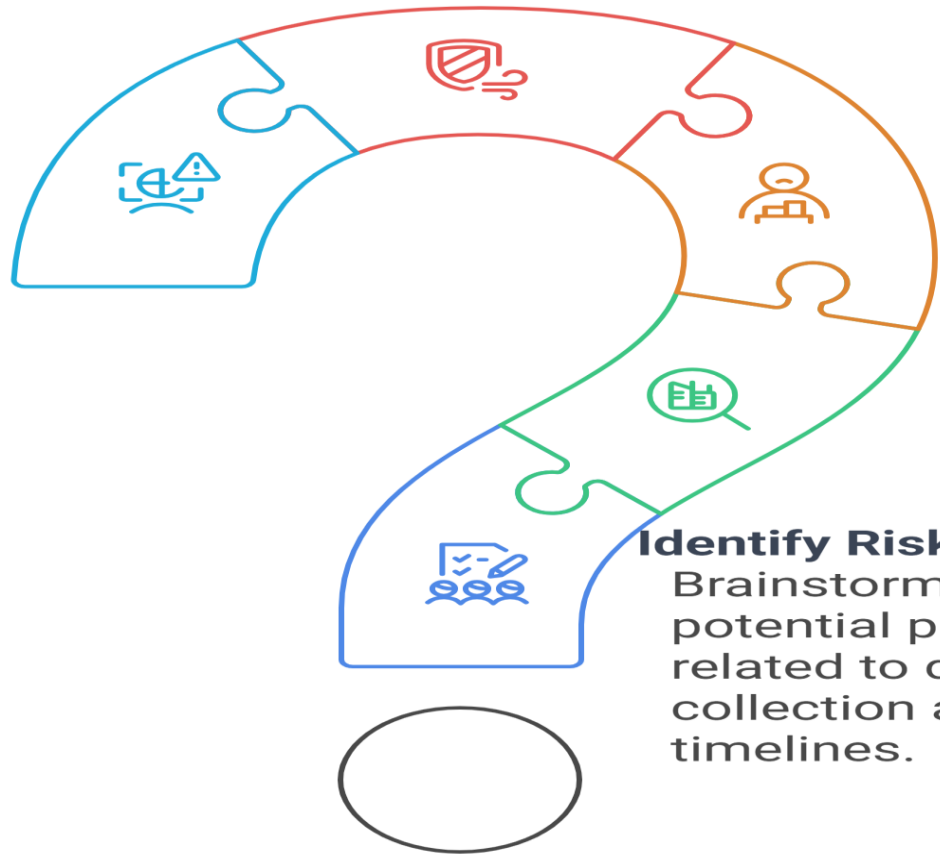
Risk Management Process for Research

Treat Risks

Develop and implement a plan to address prioritized risks.

Monitor and Review

Continuously track risks and update strategies as needed.



Evaluate/Rank Risks

Prioritize risks based on likelihood and impact.

Analyze Risks

Determine the likelihood and impact of each identified risk.

Identify Risks

Brainstorm and list potential problems related to data collection and project timelines.



How to mitigate risks in data collection?

Recruitment Challenges

Offer incentives, pilot test methods, and build a recruitment buffer.

Data Quality Issues

Use standardized instruments, clear instructions, and thorough training.

Technical Failures

Have backup equipment or alternative methods ready.

Project Risk Mitigation

Risk Transfer

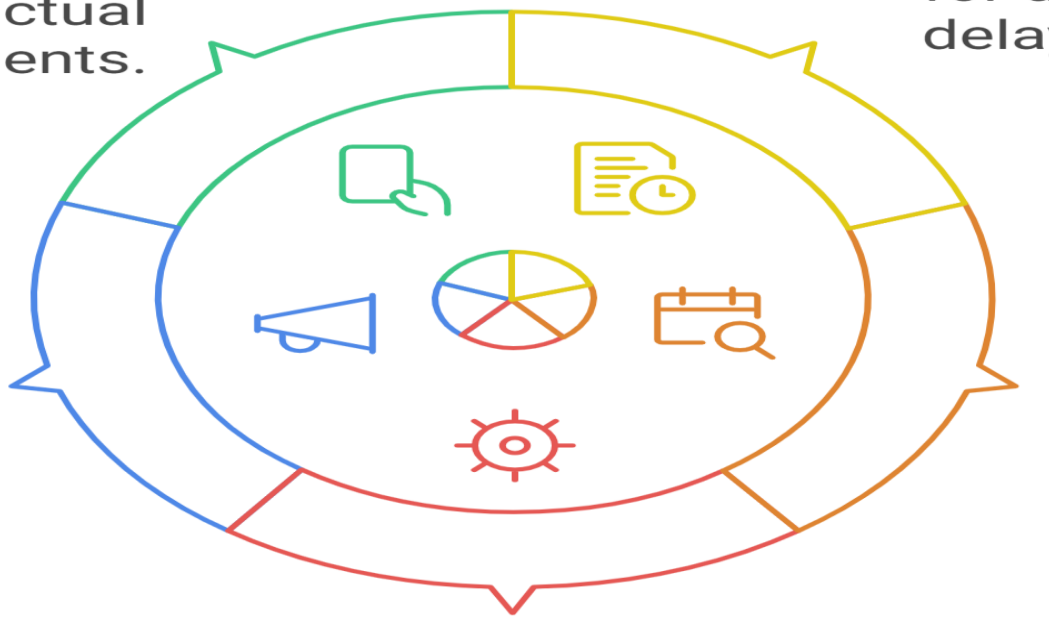
For significant financial risks associated with project delays, consider transferring them through insurance or contractual agreements.

Building in Buffers

Add contingency time to your project schedule to account for unforeseen delays.

Clear Communication

Maintain open lines of communication with your team and stakeholders, establishing a regular reporting cadence for accountability.



Realistic Planning

Base your timeline on historical data and pilot study results, rather than overly optimistic estimates.

Effective Resource Management

Ensure adequate resources are allocated to each task and have plans in place for resource availability.